

Your first day on SalonForge.

Nothing to memorise. Read this once before your setup call, then keep it for the team.

BEFORE YOUR CALL

What to have ready.

Your setup call is 45 minutes. We pre-load your salon beforehand, so the call is a walk through your own diary — not an hour of typing.

- **Opening hours** — the weekly pattern, and any days you're closed.
- **Your team** — names, roles, and the days each person works.
- **Your services** — name, price and how long each takes. An export from your old system is perfect.
- **The iPad you'll weigh colour on** — ColorLab needs iPadOS 18, so an iPad from 2019 or newer (iPad 7th gen, Air 3, mini 5, or any Pro).
- **A scale, if you have one** — ColorLab works without one; you can type the grams.
- **Whether you run a bar** — coffee, drinks to the chair. If yes, we set the Bar app up too.

Moving from another system? We bring your clients, history and diary across as part of setup — the easiest route is an export from your current software, or asking their support to send it to you and copying us in.

GETTING IN

Three apps, one salon.

Everything reads from the same booking record. Here is how to get into each one.

Daviana — booking

1. Open daviana.salonforge.com in any browser, or install the desktop app for Mac or Windows from [the downloads page](#).
2. Sign in with the login we sent you, then your PIN.
3. You'll land on today's diary.
4. **Desktop app only:** on first launch it asks for a licence key. The owner generates one per computer in Daviana → *Desktop Licenses* → *Generate Key*; a key activates one machine, and the same page shows every connected device and lets you revoke a key if a computer is replaced. We do this with you on your setup call.

ColorLab — colour

1. On the salon iPad, install ColorLab from the [App Store](#).
2. Open it, tap **Connect**, and enter the setup code from your welcome email.
3. The owner's console lives at login.colorlab.co.uk — set your password from the activation link we send you.

Bar — drinks to the chair

If your salon runs a bar, we install the Bar app on your setup call and connect it to your diary.

MODULE 1

Welcome to SalonForge.

One system for the whole floor: the diary and till (Daviana), colour weighed and charged to the bill (ColorLab), drinks to the chair (Bar), and a receptionist who answers the phone when you can't (Aria).

- **No lock-in.** Leave any time and take all your data with you.
- **Nothing to integrate.** Colour and bar charges land on the client's bill by themselves — no third-party fees, no double entry.
- **Who you'll meet:** Vincenzo and Victoria run your setup call; Sarkis builds Daviana and looks after your data; anything at all goes to info@salonforge.com.

Video: coming — a 5–10 minute walkthrough of this module.

MODULE 2

Setting up your salon.

We pre-load this from what you send us. On the call you check it, and change anything that's wrong.

- **Hours** — the weekly template, plus one-off changes (a bank holiday, a late night).
- **Team** — each person, their role, and their rota. Holidays are booked from the roster, not the diary.
- **Services and categories** — grouped the way you think about them. If a colour should never be booked without a cut, we link the categories.
- **Payment types** — we add a *Test* type that isn't banked, so you can practise checkouts without touching your figures.
- **Reminders** — email or SMS (SMS is 6p a message). Older clientele often prefer email.

Video: coming — a 5–10 minute walkthrough of this module.

MODULE 3

Managing your diary.

The day view reads like a spreadsheet: one column per stylist. Green means paid and finished.

- **Book** — click the slot, pick the client (or create one right there), pick the service. Durations are yours, not a default.
- **Move** — drag the booking. Breaks and holidays sit in the diary too.
- **Check in** — one click on the name. Everyone on reception sees the client has arrived, and the stylist gets a ping.
- **Checkout** — the bill already has the colour and bar charges on it. Take payment, split it if you need to, add a discount with a note.
- **Walk-ins and the waitlist** — a walk-in is a booking that starts now; the waitlist fills gaps when someone cancels.

Video: coming — a 5–10 minute walkthrough of this module.

MODULE 4

Clients and marketing.

The client card is where the salon's memory lives.

- **Notes** — the formula, the preferences, the things you'd want the next stylist to know.
- **Per-client pricing** — “£80 not £100, every time”, with a reason on the card.
- **Rebooking** — the next appointment is one tap at the chair; Daviana shows who hasn't rebooked.
- **Consent** — email and SMS consent are separate switches on the card. We honour whatever came across from your old system.
- **Campaigns** — ask us what's available for email and SMS campaigns; we'll set it up with you rather than promise a date here.

Video: coming — a 5–10 minute walkthrough of this module.

MODULE 5

Reports and insights.

Two places to look every day, one every week.

- **Till reconciliation** (Reports) — what was taken today, by payment type.
- **Manager → Sales** — by stylist, by service, by product.
- **ColorLab console** — what colour actually costs you per service, from the grams your team weighed.

Video: coming — a 5–10 minute walkthrough of this module.

MODULE 6

Advanced features.

Once the basics are habit.

- **Courses** — pay for five, get six; Daviana tracks the balance.
- **Colour charged to the gram** — ColorLab puts the real amount on the bill the moment the bowl is weighed. No blank surcharge line to remember.
- **Bar** — an order to the chair posts to the bill and deducts stock.
- **Aria** — the AI receptionist answers, books and takes messages when you're busy or closed.

Video: coming — a 5–10 minute walkthrough of this module.

MODULE 7

Best practices.

What the salons that get the most from SalonForge do.

- **Charge for colour honestly.** Weigh every bowl. The number does the talking — clients accept a fair, explained charge.
- **Rebook at the chair.** It's the single biggest lever on the diary.
- **Check clients in.** It's one click and it keeps the whole floor in sync.
- **Notes on the card, not in heads.** The next stylist will thank you.
- **Count stock when asked.** Real counts make the reorder right.

Video: coming — a 5–10 minute walkthrough of this module.

IF SOMETHING DOESN'T WORK

The four things that catch people out.

Each has a two-minute fix.

- **Windows: double-clicking Daviana does nothing.** Windows *Smart App Control* blocks apps whose publisher it can't verify. Use Daviana in the browser instead, or turn Smart App Control off in Windows Security → App & browser control.
 - **Mac: Daviana says it can't update.** It was opened from the download, not installed. Quit it (⌘Q), drag it into *Applications*, open it from there.
 - **ColorLab won't install.** The iPad is too old for iPadOS 18. You need an iPad from 2019 or newer.
 - **The setup code is refused.** It's four groups of four, with hyphens, and not case-sensitive. If it still won't take, reply to your welcome email — we'll check it in seconds.
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QUESTIONS SALONS ASK

Straight answers.

- **Can I book holidays for a whole period?** Yes — roster → repeat the day off to a date.
 - **Can colour be stopped from being booked without a cut?** Yes — linked categories, set up on your call.
 - **Can reminders go by email instead of SMS?** Yes — Manager → Notifications.
 - **Can I give one client a different price every time?** Yes — custom pricing on the client card, with a note.
 - **Can I practise a checkout without it counting?** Yes — the non-banked *Test* payment type; turn receipts off while you practise.
 - **Does the colour charge go on the bill automatically?** Yes — that's ColorLab's job.
 - **Something you can't see here?** Ask on your call — we keep a list for Sarkis and answer in writing.
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Questions: info@salonforge.com · Your codes: <https://salonforge.com/welcome/> · This guide online:
<https://salonforge.com/welcome/guide/>